than extradited.[71] Six months after receiving India's first dossier and only days before the prime ministers of the two countries met at a summit of non-aligned countries in Sharm el-Sheikh, Egypt, Pakistan presented its own dossier to India. It contained the first official admission that Pakistani nationals from Lashkar were responsible for planning and executing the Mumbai attacks.[72] The group had undertaken or supported many attacks against India over the years, but the target selection and operational theatrics meant that Mumbai was like no other it ever perpetrated. What still remained unanswered was what led Lashkar to stage such a terrorist spectacular.

Making Sense of Mumbai

The Director General of the ISI, Shuja Pasha, reportedly sought to answer this question when he visited Zaki-ur Rehman Lakhvi in jail following the latter's detention in the wake of the attacks.[73] The picture that emerges is one of a more modest operation in the works for some time, which rapidly expanded at the end as a result of internal dynamics. David Headley, the Pakistani-American who conducted surveillance for the Mumbai attacks, has provided the most thorough accounting to date of how the plan developed. US authorities arrested Headley in October 2009 in connection with another terrorist plot, and he agreed to cooperate in order to avoid the death penalty in America and extradition to India.[74] Investigators from India's National Investigation Agency interrogated Headley for thirty-four hours in the presence of his lawyers and officials from the US Federal Bureau of Investigation in early June 2010. This section draws heavily on the testimony he gave to them, which places significant explanatory power in the hands of one witness. Nevertheless, it is a thorough insider account of how Lashkar planned the Mumbai attacks and one which US and Indian officials told the author they have corroborated through other evidence, including Headley's travel records, Kasab's testimony, communications intercepts and various intelligence sources. In addition, the following makes use of additional open source material for corroborative purposes wherever possible.

According to Headley, Lashkar's leadership was involved heavily in selecting the targets. He also confirmed Kasab's statement to an Indian